

5-Channel Social Media Automation

Project Proposal — Phase 1A

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THE SITUATION

You have two n8n workflows that work in isolation:

- HeyGen workflow — generates avatar videos
- Blotato posting workflow — publishes to TikTok, LinkedIn, Facebook, and Instagram

The problem: they don't talk to each other. There's no central orchestration layer. Every post still requires a manual trigger, which defeats the point of automation.

Phase 1A wires them together through a single Google Sheets CMS so the system runs on its own.

WHAT WE'RE BUILDING

GOOGLE SHEETS CMS — THE ORCHESTRATION LAYER

Google Sheets becomes the single source of truth. Every piece of content lives in one place. Workflows read from it and write back to it. Nothing posts unless Sheets says it's ready.

Field	Purpose
topic	What the post is about
content_type	Reel, photo, or carousel
platform	TikTok, LinkedIn, Facebook, Instagram
status	ready → locked → posting → done / failed
scheduled_time	When to post
drive_file_id	Generated media location in Google Drive
post_id	Platform's returned confirmation ID
attempt_count	Retry counter
error_log	Last error message if failed

WORKFLOW ADAPTATIONS

HeyGen Workflow — input swapped from hardcoded source to Sheets row trigger. Generates video, saves to Google Drive, writes file ID back to the row, sets status to ready_to_post.

Blotato Channel Nodes — existing posting nodes for all 4 channels are kept. Only the input source changes: Blotato replaced with Sheets queue.

Queue collision prevention: the moment a workflow picks up a row, it sets status to 'locked' before doing

anything else. A second instance seeing 'locked' skips — no duplicate posts.

CHANNELS IN PHASE 1A

Channel	Content Type	Status
TikTok	Avatar reels	Included
LinkedIn	Photos + carousels	Included
Facebook	Reels + photos + carousels	Included
Instagram	Reels + photos + carousels	Included
YouTube	Shorts	Phase 1B

MILESTONE BREAKDOWN

Week 1 Sheets Schema + HeyGen

- Google Sheets CMS built (Content Queue, Settings tabs)
- HeyGen workflow updated to read from Sheets
- Generated videos save to Google Drive
- Row status updates correctly after generation

Checkpoint: HeyGen generates an avatar video from a Sheets row with no manual input

Week 2 Publisher Workflows Live

- Blotato channel nodes updated to read from Sheets queue
- Queue lock pattern implemented — no duplicate posts
- Rate limit counters active (daily TikTok cap, carousel counters)
- All 4 channels posting successfully from queue (manual trigger to test)

Checkpoint: One complete cycle runs: row in queue → video generates → posts to all 4 channels → row updates to done

Week 3 Stability + Handoff

- End-to-end automated run (no manual trigger)
- Basic error logging (failed rows clearly marked in Sheets)
- Cross-platform testing across all content types
- Handoff: Sheets schema docs, workflow logic, how to add new content rows

Checkpoint: System completes one full automated cycle with no manual input, posts correctly to all 4 channels

WHAT'S DEFERRED

Feature	Reason for deferral
Content generator (News API + GPT-4 + image gen)	Phase 1A uses manual Sheets input — you write topics directly
Advanced retry (exponential backoff)	Basic failure logging only; manual fix on failed rows
Telegram monitoring	Phase 1B
YouTube Shorts	Same architecture, added in Phase 1B
Carousel automation	Counter logic deferred; carousels added manually for v1
Approval/review toggle	Phase 2 feature

Important trade-off: Without the content generator, you write topics into Sheets manually for Phase 1A. The '5 minutes/day' goal is not fully achieved yet — closer to 15-20 minutes. Phase 1B eliminates that. The trade-off is intentional: prove the publishing layer first, then automate the input.

INFRASTRUCTURE

n8n hosting: Start on n8n cloud (\$20/month). Avoids Docker/SSL/backup overhead while workflows are being proven. Migration to self-hosted VPS (Hetzner CX21, €5/month) is a JSON export/import — 30 minutes — once Phase 1A is stable.

ONGOING API COSTS (YOUR OPERATIONAL COSTS, SEPARATE FROM BUILD FEE)

Service	Monthly estimate
HeyGen (60 videos/month)	\$80 – 120
DALL-E 3 (photos)	\$7
n8n cloud	\$20
Total	~\$107 – 147 / month

INVESTMENT

Phase 1A (4 channels, 3 weeks)	\$1,200 – \$1,500
Phase 1B add-on (content gen, retry, Telegram, YouT	\$800 – \$1,000
Full Phase 1A + 1B	\$2,000 – \$2,500

The range on Phase 1A depends on the condition of your existing workflows. Once I review them (JSON export from n8n or a 2-minute Loom of the canvas), I'll give you a single fixed number — no range.

PAYMENT TERMS — PHASE 1A

50% upfront · 50% on completion (stable automated run across all 4 channels)

NEXT STEP

Share your existing workflows — export as JSON from n8n, or record a 2-minute Loom of the workflow canvas. That's all I need to lock in the fixed price and confirm the start date.

If a 20-minute call is faster, I can work around your schedule this week.